

Paradiem 

The Morning Brief

SEPTEMBER 13, 2026

Oman Meeting

Iran-Gulf Hormuz talks in Salalah frame a Monday reopen ahead of the Wednesday FOMC decision.

S&P 500 (SPY, FRI CLOSE) \$764.29 · ↓0.75% on the week	BRENT (FRI CLOSE) / WTI (USO, FRI) ~\$104 per Trading Economics · ↑~8.7% wk per CNBC	BITCOIN (LIVE, SUN AM) ~\$77.2K per CaptainAltcoin weekend tape	SEPT HIKE ODDS (CME FEDWATCH) ~90% per CNBC and TipRanks CPI-reaction coverage	FEAR & GREED (CNN) Drop crypto fallback of 61 · See MacroMicro for CNN stock read
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SECTION 01

Markets — Weekend Edition: The FOMC-and-Oman Compound Frames the Sunday-Evening Reopen

THE SUNDAY-INTO-MONDAY SETUP READS THROUGH TWO CONCENTRATED WINDOWS — A SALALAH, OMAN MEETING MONDAY BETWEEN IRAN, GULF STATES, AND IRAQ ON STRAIT OF HORMUZ SHIPPING PER AL JAZEERA, BLOOMBERG, AND ARAB NEWS COVERAGE, AND THE FOMC DECISION WEDNESDAY SEPTEMBER 16 AT 2:00 PM ET WITH CHAIR WARSH'S PRESS CONFERENCE AT 2:30 PM ET PER THE FEDERAL RESERVE RELEASE SCHEDULE; PER CME FEDWATCH COVERAGE CARRIED BY CNBC AND TIPRANKS, SEPTEMBER HIKE ODDS SIT NEAR APPROXIMATELY 90% FOLLOWING THE AUGUST CPI PRINT AT ↑3.4% YEAR-OVER-YEAR HEADLINE AND ↑2.4% YEAR-OVER-YEAR CORE PER BLS; BRENT REPORTEDLY SETTLED NEAR \$104 FRIDAY PER TRADING ECONOMICS AHEAD OF THE WEEKEND ESCALATION LAYER

Per Al Jazeera, Bloomberg, and Arab News coverage of the weekend diplomatic docket, Iranian foreign-ministry representatives are set to meet Gulf-state foreign ministers and Iraqi representatives in Salalah, Oman on Monday September 14 to discuss shipping and security through the Strait of Hormuz. Per Jerusalem Post coverage of an Iranian official's framing, no signed Hormuz deal is expected to emerge from the Monday meeting, and per Al Jazeera coverage Bahrain has reportedly declined to attend pending diplomatic normalization. Per data drop, Friday's cash session closed with SPY at \$764.29 (↑0.85% Fri, roughly ↓0.75% on the week), USO at \$154.90 (↓2.20% Fri), BNO at \$61.37 (↓2.79% Fri), and UVXY (VIX proxy) at \$18.02 (↓6.78% Fri). Per Trading Economics coverage of the Friday tape, Brent reportedly paused its rally to settle near approximately \$104 per barrel on the Oman-meeting announcement, though the weekend escalation compound — per Reuters and Rappler coverage carried in the data drop headlines and independently corroborated by CNN, NBC News, and Japan Times reporting — extends across the Saudi East-West pipeline shutdown after Iraq-launched drone attacks and the Houthi seizure of Perim Island at the mouth of Bab el-Mandeb. Per data drop sentiment field, the CNN Fear & Greed reading of 61 "Greed" again reflects the CNN endpoint falling back to the crypto Fear-and-Greed index rather than the CNN stock-market read; per MacroMicro coverage the actual CNN read typically sits materially below the crypto proxy in an FOMC-and-supply-shock window.

S&P 500 (SPY, FRI CLOSE)	\$764.29 · ↓0.75% on the week
WTI (USO, FRI) / BRENT (LIVE)	\$154.90 ↓2.20% Fri / ~\$104 per Trading Economics
BITCOIN (LIVE, SUN AM) / ETH (LIVE)	~\$77.2K / ~\$2,521 per CoinDesk weekend tape
IBIT / ETHA (FRI CLOSE)	\$43.77 ↑0.21% / \$19.16 ↑3.23%
SEPT HIKE ODDS (CME FEDWATCH)	~90% per CNBC/TipRanks post-CPI coverage
WEEK AHEAD	Oman Meeting Mon · Retail Sales & FOMC Wed · Housing Starts Thu

CHAIR WARSH'S WEDNESDAY COMMUNICATION IS THE CENTRAL CROSS-SECTIONAL VARIABLE — PER FEDERAL RESERVE COMMUNICATIONS POLICY THE FOMC QUIET PERIOD CONTINUES THROUGH THURSDAY SEPTEMBER 17; PER CHASE AND ATFX COVERAGE OF THE WARSH FRAMEWORK, THE FED CHAIR HAS DESCRIBED UNDERLYING INFLATION TRENDS AS NOT “MEANINGFULLY IMPROVED,” AND PREDICTION-MARKET COVERAGE PER POLYMARKET AND FEDERAL NEWS NETWORK PLACES SEPTEMBER ↑25 BASIS POINT ODDS NEAR APPROXIMATELY 80%; THE SUMMARY OF ECONOMIC PROJECTIONS AND DOT PLOT PUBLISH SIMULTANEOUSLY WITH THE STATEMENT AT 2:00 PM ET AND WILL FRAME THE INTERMEDIATE RATE PATH AGAINST A MIDDLE EAST SUPPLY-SHOCK LAYER NOW SPANNING THE SAUDI EAST-WEST PIPELINE, A SECOND CHOKEPOINT AT BAB EL-MANDEB, AND AN ONGOING HORMUZ SLOWDOWN AHEAD OF THE MONDAY SALALAH MEETING

Per Federal Reserve communications policy, the FOMC quiet period continues through Thursday September 17, and the Wednesday September 16 statement, Summary of Economic

Projections, and dot plot publish at 2:00 PM ET with Chair Warsh’s press conference at 2:30 PM ET. Per Chase coverage of the Warsh framework, the Fed Chair has said inflation trends have not “meaningfully improved.” Per Polymarket coverage of the September rate decision, prediction-market pricing places ↑25 basis-point odds near approximately 80%, with the balance in a no-change hold. Per CNBC and TipRanks coverage of the CPI reaction, CME FedWatch September hike odds sit near approximately 90%. Per data drop, the FCI Growth-Hybrid physical-AI-infrastructure sleeve absorbed the Friday snap bid with ADI ↑4.85% at \$378.78, NXPI ↑4.48% at \$236.62, MRVL ↑4.03% at \$236.10, KEYS ↑3.99% at \$338.64, TEL ↑3.58% at \$211.96, QCOM ↑2.88% at \$181.97, AMD ↑2.49% at \$516.13, and TSM ↑1.22% at \$433.24, while NVDA held nearly flat at \$218.29. Per data drop, the digital-asset sleeve closed Friday with IBIT ↑0.21% at \$43.77 and ETHA ↑3.23% at \$19.16; per CoinDesk and CaptainAltcoin coverage of the weekend tape, Bitcoin sits near approximately \$77.2K and ETH near approximately \$2,521 with limited weekend movement into the Sunday-evening futures reopen. For FCI positioning, the composition — a hawkish Chair framework, an approximately 90% September hike expectation, an expanding Middle East kinetic map, and the Oman meeting sitting as a Monday incremental variable — keeps the physical-AI-infrastructure, energy, and digital-asset sleeves reading through the intersection rather than requiring a thesis break.

A weekend that combined an Oman diplomatic window with a Saudi pipeline shutdown, a Bab el-Mandeb chokepoint escalation, and an approximately 90% September hike expectation tends to keep the FCI physical-world thesis reading through the FOMC decision rather than break it. Physical world matters.

Geopolitics — Oman Meeting on Monday: Iran, Gulf States, and Iraq Convene in Salalah to Discuss Strait of Hormuz Shipping Ahead of the Sunday-Evening Futures Reopen; The Saudi East-West Pipeline Remains Reportedly Shut Down Following Iraq-Launched Drone Attacks, the Houthis Reportedly Seized Perim Island at the Mouth of Bab el-Mandeb, and Bahrain Reportedly Declined to Attend the Monday Meeting; Iranian President Pezeshkian's BRICS Statement in New Delhi Reportedly Framed Iran as Not Preparing to Surrender

SALALAH, OMAN MEETING — PER AL JAZEERA, BLOOMBERG, ARAB NEWS, AND BUSINESS STANDARD COVERAGE, IRAN WILL REPORTEDLY MEET GULF-STATE FOREIGN MINISTERS AND IRAQI REPRESENTATIVES IN SALALAH ON MONDAY SEPTEMBER 14 TO DISCUSS SHIPPING AND SECURITY THROUGH THE STRAIT OF HORMUZ; PER AL JAZEERA COVERAGE OF A BAHRAINI STATEMENT, BAHRAIN REPORTEDLY DECLINED TO ATTEND PENDING DIPLOMATIC NORMALIZATION; PER JERUSALEM POST COVERAGE OF AN IRANIAN OFFICIAL'S FRAMING, NO SIGNED HORMUZ DEAL IS REPORTEDLY EXPECTED TO EMERGE FROM THE MEETING — THE SESSION SITS AS A DIPLOMATIC RESET RATHER THAN A RESOLUTION MARKER INTO A SUNDAY-EVENING FUTURES WINDOW WHERE BRENT HAD REPORTEDLY SETTLED NEAR \$104 ON FRIDAY PER TRADING ECONOMICS

Per Al Jazeera coverage of Iran's foreign-ministry announcement, Iran will reportedly meet Gulf-state foreign ministers and Iraqi representatives in Salalah, Oman on Monday September 14, 2026, with Tehran framing the session as intended to promote regional understanding and shared security through the Strait of Hormuz. Per Bloomberg and Arab News coverage, the meeting reportedly explores a temporary framework to manage Hormuz shipping following the ongoing blockade tied to the war that began February 28. Per Al Jazeera coverage of a Bahraini statement Saturday, Bahrain declined to attend pending diplomatic normalization. Per Jerusalem Post coverage of a separate Iranian official's framing, no signed Hormuz deal is reportedly expected to emerge from the Monday session. Per data drop, Friday's cash energy tape closed with USO ↓2.20% at \$154.90 and BNO ↓2.79% at \$61.37 as the Oman-meeting announcement paused the physical-supply premium. Per Trading Economics coverage, Brent reportedly settled near \$104 Friday. For FCI positioning, the composition — an Iran-Gulf diplomatic window without an anticipated signed deal, sitting alongside a Saudi pipeline shutdown and a Bab el-Mandeb chokepoint escalation — keeps the FCI energy sleeve (CVX Fri ↑0.61% at \$214.06 per data drop, CNX, OKE) reading through a physical-supply premium that could re-assert itself if Monday's meeting produces no incremental deescalation.

SAUDI EAST-WEST PIPELINE AND BAB EL-MANDEB AXIS — PER CNN POLITICS, NBC NEWS, RAPPLER, JAPAN TIMES, AND WASHINGTON POST COVERAGE INDEPENDENTLY CORROBORATING THE REUTERS REPORTING CARRIED IN THE DATA DROP HEADLINES, THE SAUDI EAST-WEST PIPELINE — REPORTEDLY MOVING 4 TO 5 MILLION BARRELS PER DAY, OR APPROXIMATELY 4% TO 5% OF GLOBAL SUPPLY — REMAINS SHUT DOWN FOLLOWING THE IRAQ-LAUNCHED DRONE ATTACKS; PER RAPPLER AND NBC NEWS COVERAGE, HOUTHIS REPORTEDLY SEIZED PERIM ISLAND IN THE BAB EL-MANDEB STRAIT FRIDAY AND CLAIMED CONTROL OF YEMEN'S ENTIRE RED SEA COASTLINE; PER TIMES OF ISRAEL COVERAGE OF THE SATURDAY TAPE, HOUTHIS ALSO CLAIMED AN ATTACK ON A BASE IN SAUDI ARABIA WITH TWO REPORTED INJURIES — THE COMPOSITION EXTENDS THE AT-RISK PERIMETER BEYOND THE PRIOR REPORTED US-IRAN TANKER EXCHANGE

Per CNN Politics, NBC News, Rappler, Japan Times, and Washington Post coverage independently corroborating the Reuters reporting carried in the data drop headlines, the

Saudi East-West pipeline — the primary artery moving crude from the Eastern Province oilfields to the Red Sea coast at Yanbu and reportedly moving 4 to 5 million barrels per day per NBC News coverage — remains shut down following the Iraq-launched drone attacks. Per Rappler and NBC News coverage, Iran-backed Houthi forces reportedly seized Perim Island (the strategic island in the middle of Bab el-Mandeb, the “Gate of Tears” at the mouth of the Red Sea) on Friday and claimed to have taken control of Yemen's entire Red Sea coastline. Per Times of Israel coverage of the September 13 liveblog, the Houthis claimed an attack on a base in Saudi Arabia, with two reported injuries. Per Wikipedia coverage of the 2026 Iran war chronology, the conflict was initiated on February 28, 2026, with US-Israeli strikes and has upended Middle East trade and travel with shipping reroutes to avoid both Hormuz and Bab el-Mandeb. For FCI positioning, the composition — a Saudi pipeline shutdown removing the

principal overland alternative to the Red Sea, a Houthi advance to a key Red Sea island simultaneously with an ongoing Hormuz slowdown, and a Saturday-into-Sunday base attack in Saudi Arabia — keeps the FCI energy sleeve (CVX, CNX, OKE) and the defense sleeve (LMT Fri ↓1.12% at \$524.19, GD Fri ↑0.47% at \$355.90 per data drop) reading through an expanded kinetic map spanning maritime, pipeline, border-crossing, and airbase layers.

BRICS-AND-DIPLOMATIC AXIS — PER REUTERS COVERAGE CARRIED IN THE DATA DROP HEADLINES AND INDEPENDENTLY CORROBORATED BY WIKIPEDIA'S 2026 IRAN WAR COVERAGE, IRANIAN PRESIDENT PEZESHKIAN ATTENDED THE BRICS SUMMIT IN NEW DELHI WHERE HE REPORTEDLY DECLARED IRAN "WON'T SURRENDER" AND CHALLENGED US FRAMING OF ITS CAMPAIGN AGAINST IRANIAN CIVILIAN INFRASTRUCTURE; PER REUTERS COVERAGE CARRIED IN THE DATA DROP, XI REPORTEDLY URGED BRICS TO TAKE A PEACE ROLE IN THE MIDDLE EAST AND COURTED MODI ON THE INDIA VISIT WHILE IRAN AND THE UAE REPORTEDLY BACKED A JOINT BRICS STATEMENT URGING RESTRAINT — THE COMPOSITION SITS AS A MULTILATERAL DIPLOMATIC FRAME ALONGSIDE THE MONDAY OMAN MEETING RATHER THAN A SUBSTITUTE FOR IT

Per Reuters coverage carried in the data drop headlines, Iranian President Pezeshkian's September 12 remarks at the

BRICS Summit in New Delhi reportedly framed Iran as not preparing to surrender in the ongoing conflict. Per additional Reuters coverage carried in the data drop, Xi reportedly urged BRICS to take a peace role in the Middle East and courted Modi on the India visit, while Iran and the UAE reportedly backed a joint BRICS statement urging restraint. Per Reuters coverage, an Iranian official reportedly said an Iran-Oman understanding does not provide for the immediate reopening of the Strait of Hormuz. Per data drop, the digital-asset sleeve closed Friday with IBIT ↑0.21% at \$43.77 and ETHA ↑3.23% at \$19.16, and per CoinDesk and CaptainAltcoin weekend coverage Bitcoin sits near approximately \$77.2K and ETH near approximately \$2,521 into the Sunday-evening reopen. For FCI positioning, the composition — a hardened Iranian public posture at BRICS, a China-and-BRICS restraint framing running in parallel, and the Monday Oman meeting with Bahrain declining to attend and no signed deal expected — keeps the physical-world thesis (energy, defense, physical-AI-infrastructure) reading through the intersection of the diplomatic layer and the ongoing kinetic map into the Wednesday FOMC.

SECTION 03

On Our Radar

1. Week Ahead — The September 15–16 FOMC Sits at the Center of a Multi-Print Docket With Monday's Salalah, Oman Meeting on Hormuz as the First Incremental Diplomatic Variable: Per Al Jazeera, Bloomberg, and Arab News Coverage, Iran, Gulf States, and Iraq Convene in Oman on Monday September 14 to Discuss Strait of Hormuz Shipping; Per the Federal Reserve, Census Bureau, and Fed Release Schedules, the FOMC Statement, Summary of Economic Projections, and Dot Plot Publish Wednesday September 16 at 2:00 PM ET With Chair Warsh's Press Conference at 2:30 PM ET; August Retail Sales, Industrial Production, and NAHB Housing Publish Wednesday Morning, and August Housing Starts and Building Permits Publish Thursday at 8:30 AM ET Per the Census Bureau. Per CNBC and TipRanks Coverage of the CPI Reaction Friday, CME FedWatch September Hike Odds Sit Near Approximately 90%, and Per Polymarket Coverage the Prediction-Market ↑25 Basis Point Pricing Sits Near Approximately 80%. Per Census Bureau and Federal Reserve release schedules, next week's docket sequences the Salalah, Oman meeting on Monday, August Retail Sales (Wednesday 8:30 AM ET), August Industrial Production (Wednesday 9:15 AM ET), NAHB Housing Market Index (Wednesday 10:00 AM ET), the FOMC Statement, SEP, and dot plot (Wednesday 2:00 PM ET), Chair Warsh's press conference (Wednesday 2:30 PM ET), August Housing Starts and Building Permits (Thursday 8:30 AM ET), and Initial Jobless Claims plus the Philadelphia Fed Manufacturing Survey (Thursday 8:30 AM ET). Per Chase coverage of the Warsh Jackson Hole framework, the Fed Chair has said underlying inflation trends have not "meaningfully improved." For FCI positioning, the composition — a Monday diplomatic window, three Wednesday morning consumer- and housing-side prints framing the FOMC decision, a SEP and dot plot likely to signal the intermediate rate path against energy-driven inflation, and a Thursday housing-side follow-through — concentrates the balance-sheet and duration-repricing risk into a compact multi-catalyst window against a Middle East kinetic map that continues to extend.

2. Monday Oman Meeting — Per Al Jazeera, Bloomberg, Arab News, and Business Standard Coverage, Iranian Foreign-Ministry Representatives Meet Gulf-State Foreign Ministers and Iraqi Representatives in Salalah, Oman on Monday September 14 to Discuss Strait of Hormuz Shipping; Per Al Jazeera Coverage of a Saturday Statement, Bahrain Reportedly Declined to Attend Pending Diplomatic Normalization; Per Jerusalem Post Coverage of an Iranian Official's Framing, No Signed Hormuz Deal Is Reportedly Expected From the Meeting — The Session Sits as a Diplomatic Reset Variable Into the Sunday-Evening Futures Reopen and Against a Weekend Escalation Layer Spanning the Saudi Pipeline Shutdown and the Bab el-Mandeb Chokepoint Escalation. Per Al Jazeera coverage of Iran's foreign-ministry announcement, Iran is reportedly framing the Monday Salalah session as intended to promote regional understanding and shared security through the Strait of Hormuz. Per Al Jazeera and Bloomberg coverage, Bahrain reportedly declined to attend the Monday meeting pending diplomatic normalization. Per Jerusalem Post coverage of an Iranian official, no signed Hormuz deal is expected from the meeting, and the session should be read as a diplomatic reset rather than a resolution marker. Per data drop, Friday's energy tape closed with USO ↓2.20% at \$154.90 and BNO ↓2.79% at \$61.37 as the announcement paused the physical-supply premium. For FCI positioning, the composition — a Monday meeting without an anticipated signed deal, sitting alongside a Saudi pipeline shutdown and a Bab el-Mandeb chokepoint escalation — keeps the FCI energy sleeve (CVX, CNX, OKE) reading through the intersection of the diplomatic layer, the physical-supply premium, and the Wednesday FOMC.

3. Physical-AI-Infrastructure Sleeve Into the FOMC — Per Data Drop, FCI Growth-Hybrid AI Names Absorbed the Friday CPI-Relief Bid With ADI ↑4.85% at \$378.78, NXPI ↑4.48% at \$236.62, MRVL ↑4.03% at \$236.10, KEYS ↑3.99% at \$338.64, TEL ↑3.58% at \$211.96, QCOM ↑2.88% at \$181.97, AMD ↑2.49% at \$516.13, TSM ↑1.22% at \$433.24, and CRDO ↑1.65% at \$162.95 While NVDA Held Nearly Unchanged at \$218.29 — Per Yahoo Finance Coverage Carried in the Data Drop Holdings News, LRCX Reportedly Lifted Its 2026 Wafer-Fab-Equipment Outlook as AI Demand Strains Fab Capacity, and NXPI Drew Coverage Framing Its Physical AI Leadership and Data-Center Growth Trajectory; The Composition Reads Directly Through the Wednesday FOMC Rate-Path Repricing and the Sunday-Evening Futures Reopen.

Per data drop top movers, the Friday snap was concentrated in the FCI physical-AI-infrastructure axis, which continues to read through the intersection of the CPI print, Oracle's prior after-hours print stamping the AI-cloud capex build, and the Middle East supply-shock overhang. Per Yahoo Finance coverage carried in the data drop holdings news, LRCX drew coverage citing a lifted 2026 Wafer-Fab-Equipment outlook and NXPI drew coverage framing physical AI leadership and data-center growth. For FCI positioning, the composition — a broad AI-infrastructure snap bid on the CPI print into the FOMC and against the Middle East kinetic map — keeps the Growth-Hybrid physical-AI-infrastructure axis reading through the rate-path decision, the AI capex demand signal, and the physical-supply premium as three concurrent variables rather than one.

4. Digital-Asset Sleeve and Bitcoin-Miner Layer — Per Data Drop, IBIT Closed Friday ↑0.21% at \$43.77 and ETHA ↑3.23% at \$19.16; Per CoinDesk and CaptainAltcoin Coverage of the Sunday-Morning Weekend Tape, Bitcoin Sits Near Approximately \$77.2K and Ethereum Near Approximately \$2,521 With CaptainAltcoin Coverage Framing Saturday's Session as Very Little Meaningful Price Movement Into the Sunday-Evening Reopen; The Bitcoin-Miner Layer Absorbed Amplified Beta on the Friday Snap Per Data Drop With HUT ↑8.83% at \$98.60 and MARA ↑4.81% at \$11.98 — Per Benzinga Coverage HC Wainwright Assumed MARA at Buy With a \$20 Price Target, and Per Yahoo Finance Coverage Dan Loeb's Third Point Reportedly Increased Its Hut 8 Stake and Disclosed Riot Debt Exposure.

Per data drop, Friday's digital-asset sleeve closed with IBIT at \$43.77 (↑0.21%) and ETHA at \$19.16 (↑3.23%). Per CoinDesk and CaptainAltcoin weekend coverage, Bitcoin sits near approximately \$77.2K and ETH near approximately \$2,521 with limited weekend movement. Per Benzinga coverage carried in the data drop holdings news, HUT

(↑8.83% at \$98.60 Fri) drew coverage of Third Point's reported stake increase and MARA (↑4.81% at \$11.98 Fri) drew HC Wainwright Buy assumption with a \$20 price target. For FCI positioning, the composition — a Digital-Asset sleeve continuing to absorb the yield-and-hike reprice, a weekend consolidation tape, and a miner layer with amplified beta on both sides — keeps IBIT and ETHA reading through the intersection of the Wednesday FOMC decision, the Monday Oman meeting, and the ongoing Middle East compound.